Signposts for Presentations

Introduction

Situation	Formal	Informal
Opening the talk	Good morning, everyone. Thank you all for coming.	Morning, everyone — thanks for making the time.
Introducing yourself	On behalf of [company], I'm [name], [position].	Hi everyone, I'm [name] from the [team] team.
Introducing the topic	The focus of today's presentation is...	I'm here today to talk to you about...
Outlining the talk	The presentation is divided into three parts. First... Following that... Finally...	I'll cover three things today. I'll start with... Then... I'll finish with...
Talking about timing	My talk will last about twenty minutes, and we'll have time for questions afterwards.	I'll keep this to fifteen minutes so we have room for your questions.
Inviting early questions	Please don't hesitate to interrupt me with your questions.	If you have any questions, please ask as we go.
Housekeeping	Before we start, please make sure your microphone is muted.	Can everyone see my screen? Give me a thumbs-up if you can.

Main Body

Situation	Formal	Informal
Introducing the first section	I'd like to begin by...	Let's start by looking at...
Moving to a new section	We've looked at... Now I'd like to discuss...	We've looked at... Now let's talk about...
Expanding on a point	I'd like to elaborate on...	Let me tell you a little more about...
Giving an example	To illustrate this point, let me give you an example from our Shanghai office.	Take our Shanghai office, for example — last quarter it did surprisingly well.
Comparing two things	In contrast to the first option, the second one costs less.	Compare these two — the second one is way cheaper.
Earlier or later points	As I mentioned earlier... More on this later.	As I said earlier... I'll talk more about this later.
Listeners' prior knowledge	As you may be aware of...	I'm sure a lot of you already know that...

Visuals and Data

Situation	Formal	Informal
Focusing on a visual	May I direct your attention to this chart...	Take a look at this slide. You can see that...
Presenting figures	According to our latest figures, sales rose by twelve percent.	Our numbers show a jump of about twelve percent.

Situation	Formal	Informal
Describing a trend	This graph shows a steady rise since March.	If you look here, it's been going up since March.
Comparing two sets	In contrast to the first quarter, the second quarter...	Compare these two bars — the left one is over twice as high.
Highlighting a key point	The important thing to remember is...	If you remember one thing today, make it this...

Handling Questions

Situation	Formal	Informal
Opening the Q&A	We now have time for questions.	Okay, let's open it up — what would you like to know?
Buying time to think	That's a good question. Let me think for a moment.	Good question — give me a second to think.
Clarifying a question	Could you be more specific about what you mean by...?	Sorry, which part do you mean exactly?
A question you didn't catch	Could you repeat that, please?	Sorry, I didn't catch that. Are you saying...?
A question you can't answer	I don't have that with me. Could I send a full reply by email?	I don't have that with me. Email me and I'll follow up today.
A difficult question	That's a fair point. Let me give you my honest view.	Good question. Honestly, it depends...
Handling an interruption	That's a good point. I'll come back to it in a moment.	Good point — can I finish this bit first?

Time, Closing and Next Steps

Situation	Formal	Informal
Managing time	We're running a little short on time, so I'll move on.	I'm almost out of time, so I'll be quick.
Bringing the talk back on track	Let's return to the main point.	Anyway — back to the main point.
Summarizing and concluding	To conclude, I'd like to summarize the main points.	Let's recap what we looked at today.
Making a recommendation	In my view, we should go with the first option.	I think Option A is the way to go.
Finishing and saying goodbye	If there are no further questions, thank you for your attention.	Well, that's about it. Thanks for listening.
Offering next steps	I'll send the slides and a short summary by Friday.	I'll drop the slides in the group chat after this.
Giving contact details	You can reach me at [email] if anything comes up.	Just message me on WeChat if you have questions.